

Introduction to Human Sciences
End Semester Examination
Spring 2026

3 May 2026
Total time: 2 hrs
Total marks: 100

Part I: Sociology Module

Marks: 40

Approx. Time: 45 minutes

Section A (Answer all questions in about 400 words)

15 x 2

1. What is Weber's typology of social action (4 marks)? What role did the idea of rationality play in the work of Weber? (11 marks).
2. How do Karl Marx and Weber differ in their understanding of how capitalism emerges as a system?

Section B (Answer the following in about 250 words)

10 x 1

3. Who conceived the idea of social fact (2 marks)? What do you mean by social fact? Explain using an example (8 marks).

Part II: Philosophy Module

Marks: 40
Approx. Time: 45 minutes

Section A:

5 x 2

1. State whether the following arguments are inductive or deductive. Also identify the type of inductive and deductive arguments they are (in terms of the labels that apply to each type in terms of sound/unsound/weak/strong/valid/invalid).

- (a) The same pattern of questions was followed in the last two years' question papers. This year too, the pattern will be similar.
- (b) The highway sign says that the risk of forest fires in this area is extremely high right now. Therefore, we must conclude that the risk of forest fires is indeed high right now.
- (c) If people are not informed about the workings of government, then they cannot vote intelligently. Since people cannot vote intelligently, it is true that that people are not informed about the workings of government.
- (d) Either the painting is a forgery, or it's worth a small fortune. Therefore, the painting is worth a small fortune, since it's not a forgery.
- (e) If the Big Bang theory is correct, then the universe is billions of years old. And if the Big Bang theory is correct, then the universe was not created in six days. Thus, if the universe is billions of years old, then it was not created in six days.

Section B:

2. Identify the following informal fallacies. Give reasons for the same. Note that each of these is representative and uniquely identifiable as the instance of a single specific fallacy. Provide the specific fallacy each falls under. Do not write multiple answers for the same question.

5 x 2

- (a) We've all heard the complaint that millions of Indians are without adequate health care. But India's doctors, nurses, and hospitals are among the best in the world. Thousands of people come from abroad every year to be treated here. Clearly there is nothing wrong with our health-care system.
- (b) Most people think ad hominem is not a fallacy, so it really doesn't matter if you commit it.
- (c) There is so much conflicting news these days. It's better to stay away from news altogether.
- (d) It is being argued that too much time on the Internet is leading to brain rot in youngsters these days. Yet a lot of content on the Internet is excellent. Youtube has so many informative and educational videos and one can connect with people from across the globe via social media. You can catch up with the latest news from all over the world. The Internet is very resourceful, indeed.

(e) The editors of the Daily Register have accused our company of being one of the city's worst water polluters. But the Daily Register is responsible for much more pollution than we are. After all, they own the Western Paper Company, and that company discharges tons of chemical residue into the city's river every day.

Section C:

3. Convert the following inferences to match with the label in the brackets. You may choose to add new premises and/or modify the premises provided wherever necessary:

10 x 2

- ~~(a)~~ You see the two of them together always. They must be dating. (valid, deductive)
- ~~(b)~~ I've taken that professor's course and noticed that she does not bother those who leave class after attendance. So if you want attendance without having to attend classes, then you can take her course. (strong, inductive)
- ~~(c)~~ Thursday follows Tuesday. Therefore, Hyderabad is the capital of Telangana. (valid, modus ponens)
- ~~(d)~~ I have so far not used cash in Hyderabad since all the shops accepted UPI payments. So you don't need to carry any cash in this city. (strong, inductive)
- ~~(e)~~ I've never seen her use a phone. She must be anti-technology (valid, deductive).
- ~~(f)~~ I never got flagged for plagiarism when i used that LLM for writing my assignments. It is foolproof. (strong, inductive).
- ~~(g)~~ If there is fuel, the motorcycle will turn on. (sound, modus tollens).
- ~~(h)~~ If there is oxygen, then there is fire. (sound, modus ponens)
- ~~(i)~~ If you exercise, then you will reduce your chances of arthritis (strong, inductive)
- ~~(j)~~ All animals are mammals. And since Jumbo is a mammal, it is also an animal (valid, deductive)

Part III:

Marks: 20

Approx. Time: 30 minutes

20 x 1

Answer any one in about 300 words:

1. What is Sociology (3 marks)? What are the three distinct phases of development of Sociology in India (3 marks)? Describe these phases briefly (14 marks).
2. Define democracy. Explain how the democratic tradition does not advance a single agreed ideal of popular rule, but instead serves as an arena of debate. Also, mention the three central questions addressed by democratic political thought.
3. You are a historian of India in the year 2500 CE. How would you reconstruct everyday life in early 21st century India? What sources would you use, what problems would you face, and how would you distinguish between reliable and misleading evidence?
4. Using the circular flow of income diagram, identify the supply and demand sides of an economy and explain how they are linked with each other.
5. Both "There Will Come Soft Rains" and "The One Percent War" show us a world in which technology is advanced enough to play a critical role in driving human lives. Pick any one of the two stories to explain the implications of such a development for human beings. (4 marks)

Then, discuss at least two specific literary features (with examples) from that story – such as language, characterization, setting, structure, and narration – that allow us to contemplate such questions. (6 marks)

6. (a) What is philosophy and what is the philosophical method grounded in (2)? What marks a philosophical question as distinct from a scientific question (2)? How has it come to be that philosophy deals almost exclusively with unanswerable questions (2)?

(b) Briefly describe the three laws of logic (3). Bring out the difference between logical impossibility and physical impossibility (2). Give examples that match the following descriptions:

- (i) logically possible but physically impossible (1)
- (ii) logically impossible but physically possible (1)

(c) Outline any 2 features that distinguish inductive from deductive arguments (3). What is the principle/ground upon which inductive and deductive inferences are founded (2)? How is it that the grounds of inductive inference involves a form of circular argument (2)?

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